

same release cycle. Notable exceptions are Microsoft's Internet Explorer and Apple's Safari. There do exist a few Linux-only browsers such as GNOME's Empathy and Midori from the Elementary Project, but neither is nearly as advanced as Firefox and Chrome.

Similarly, voice over IP service Skype is available as a native, standalone app, not requiring any special workarounds. Vuze and Transmission are popular BitTorrent clients on Linux.

IV. Utilities

Utility software are those programs that don't fall under a specific segment, but are integral to the health and upkeep of your machine. Since each operating system is different, it's not possible to find exact alternatives to Windows software. The problems encountered and maintenance required on a Linux system are very different from those on Windows. E.g. Windows users are familiar with the Defragmenting tool, used to make sure that the used data blocks in a hard drive are properly aligned with each other for optimal retrieval. Linux filesystems such as ext3/ext4 don't need this feature since they aren't prone to fragmentation. Similarly, Linux has very few viruses in the wild, and due to the nature of this OS, it's very difficult for a non-root process to go rogue and cause permanent damage. Hence, anti-viruses and anti-malware applications for Linux aren't very common, though a few certainly exist.

1. Dropbox/Insync

Everyone's favourite cloud syncing tool, Dropbox (downloadable at www.dropbox.com), has a wonderful program for Linux users. It works the same way as its Windows/OS X counterpart – by monitoring a folder on your machine and uploading any files from that folder to the cloud. You can



Dropbox fully supports Linux with a handy indicator applet for Ubuntu

instantly share any file with a web link using the right-click menu, provided you have the Nautilus File Manager extension installed.`

While Google Drive doesn't have an official client for Linux, Insync (downloadable at <https://www.insynchq.com/>), a third-